KRITAGNYA VADAR

PhD Student, Department of Biology | Case Western Reserve University, Cleveland, Ohio
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RESEARCH CAREER

PhD Student | Case Western Reserve University | Fall 2025–Present
Advisor: Dr. Yash Sondhi
Research on moth ecology, sensory biology, and the influence of artificial light at night and habitat on insect activity.

Research Assistant | Ahmedabad University | June 2024–2025
Project: Using ectoparasites (ticks) to study community and disease ecology.
Principal Investigator: Dr. Shomen Mukherjee.

Research Assistant | Gujarat Forest Department | March–May 2024
Project: Diet analysis of coastal Asiatic lion populations.
Principal Investigator: Dr. Mohan Ram, Gir National Park and Wildlife Sanctuary, Gujarat.

Project Associate | National Centre for Biological Sciences (NCBS), Bengaluru | November 2022–December 2023
Project: How well does structural connectivity translate to functional/genetic connectivity of tigers in the northeast Indian landscape?
Principal Investigator: Prof. Uma Ramakrishnan.

Master's Dissertation | The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda
Dependence of leopard (Panthera pardus) on livestock and human–leopard conflict in Jambughoda Wildlife Sanctuary.
Research Advisor: Dr. Geeta Padate.

EDUCATION

Case Western Reserve University, Cleveland, Ohio | 2025–Present
PhD in Biology (in progress)

The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, Vadodara | 2022
M.Sc. Zoology | CGPA: 7.01

The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, Vadodara | 2020
B.Sc. Zoology | CGPA: 6.10

Higher Secondary School, GSHSEB, Gandhinagar | 2017
State Board | 65.7%

Secondary School, GSHSEB, Gandhinagar | 2015
CBSE Board | 85.0%

PUBLICATIONS AND PREPRINTS

1. Ram, M., Sahu, A., Srivastava, N., **Vadar, K.**, Chaudhary, R., & Jhala, L. (2025). Dietary pattern of Asiatic lions in the coastal ecosystem of Saurashtra, Gujarat, India. *Conservation, 5*(1), 11.https://doi.org/10.3390/conservation5010011
2. Sagar, V., Ghosh, T., **Vadar, K**., Mayekar, V. K., Harihar, A., & Ramakrishnan, U. (2026). Demographic history, geographic distance, and landscape features shape the genetic divergence of wild tigers in northeast India. bioRxiv (preprint). https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.06.02.729668

GRANTS AND AWARDS

2026 | CWRU Oglebay Farm grant — summer research at the University Farm, Case Western Reserve University (insect and moth ecology).

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

Imageomics Institute 2025 All-Hands Meeting | The Ohio State University, Columbus, Ohio | April 16–18, 2025
Student Conference on Conservation Science (SCCS) | Bengaluru | October 9–12, 2023

SERB Karyashala on Next-Generation Sequencing for Molecular Ecology | NCBS, Bengaluru | August 21–27, 2023

National Training Program on Research Techniques in Wildlife and Habitat | Eastern Gir, Gujarat | January 8–12, 2021

COUNTRYBUTION 2020: “Self-Reliance Driven Leadership – Work Local, Lead Global” | Institute of Leadership & Governance | May 30–June 19, 2020

EXPERIENCE

Extensive fieldwork across landscapes including the northeast Indian plains and hills (Assam), and western Indian dry deciduous forests (Rajasthan and Gujarat).

More than one year of research experience at NCBS, Bengaluru, including molecular biology methods, sample collection and preservation, and experimental design.

Coordinated a webinar series for WCB Research Foundation, Patan, Gujarat, India.

SKILLS AND ABILITIES

- Planning and conducting non-invasive carnivore sampling
- Wet-lab techniques for genetic analysis of biological samples
- Communication in English, Hindi, and Gujarati
- Statistical analysis using R and python, and geographic information systems (QGIS)
- Karate (blue belt) and national-level sports medals
- Fieldwork involving long-distance trekking and extended sampling hours

REFERENCES

Dr. Yash Sondhi
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Email: yxs1621@case.edu

Prof. Uma Ramakrishnan
National Centre for Biological Sciences, Bengaluru 560065, India
Email: uramakri@ncbs.res.in